AQUASENTINEL: AGENTIC FLOOD RESPONSE AND EVACUATION OPTIMIZATION WITH DIGITAL TWIN

A Project Report

U23ADS705 - Mini Project

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

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U23ADS705 - MINI PROJECT - DECLARATION FORM

Declaration by the Student(s)

We hereby declare that the project titled "AQUASENTINEL: AGENTIC FLOOD RESPONSE AND EVACUATION OPTIMIZATION WITH DIGITAL TWIN" is an original work carried out by us under the guidance of MR. NANDAKUMAR T. This project has not been submitted elsewhere for the award of any degree.

We also affirm that all the data and information used in this project are genuine and properly acknowledged. This project work is carried out with reference to the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals SDG 11 – Sustainable Cities and Communities and SDG 13 – Climate Action.

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ABSTRACT

Floods are the most frequent natural disaster in India, and the time between a rising river and an overwhelmed road network is often only a few hours. Existing tools usually forecast the hazard or display it on a map, but rarely connect the forecast to the decisions that follow: whether to evacuate, which shelter still has space, which road is open and which rescue team should go first.

This project presents AquaSentinel, an agentic real-time flood response and evacuation optimization system with a digital twin. A single Sense, Predict, Reason, Decide, Optimize and Respond pipeline collects live weather and river-stage data from Open-Meteo, scores it with machine-learning models trained on the INDOFLOODS and CAMELS-IND datasets, and combines the result with rainfall and stage-versus-danger terms in a documented risk engine. A gated policy chooses MONITOR, HUMAN REVIEW or AUTOMATED RESPONSE, and seven cooperating agents record every step as an auditable event. Flood-aware routes are computed with Dijkstra, A* and Yen's algorithm, zone-to-shelter assignment is solved as a QUBO problem with greedy, simulated-annealing and QAOA-inspired solvers, and SOS calls are clustered with K-means and served vulnerable-first. A digital twin and a five-dam monitor reuse the same pipeline on synthetic scenarios.

The system is built with React and Vite, FastAPI, MongoDB, scikit-learn, XGBoost, SHAP and NetworkX, with WebSocket updates and Docker deployment. The production 3-day flood forecast reached a balanced accuracy of 0.898, recall of 0.902 and ROC-AUC of 0.965 on gauges never seen in training. In a seed-fixed benchmark of 30 synthetic scenarios, constraint-aware HQRL routing achieved 100 percent safe evacuation with no capacity violations, against 90 percent for shortest-path and RL-only routing.

Keywords: flood forecasting, digital twin, multi-agent systems, evacuation routing, QUBO, explainable AI, XGBoost.

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

Abbreviation	Expansion
A*	A-star heuristic shortest-path search
AI	Artificial Intelligence
API	Application Programming Interface
AUC	Area Under the Curve
CAMELS-IND	Catchment Attributes and Meteorology for Large-sample Studies in India
CORS	Cross-Origin Resource Sharing
CWC	Central Water Commission
FRL	Full Reservoir Level
HQRL	Hybrid Quantum Reinforcement Learning
JWT	JSON Web Token
LLM	Large Language Model
ML	Machine Learning
MSL	Mean Sea Level
NDRF	National Disaster Response Force
PPO	Proximal Policy Optimization
PR-AUC	Area Under the Precision and Recall Curve
QAOA	Quantum Approximate Optimization Algorithm
QUBO	Quadratic Unconstrained Binary Optimization
RBAC	Role-Based Access Control
REST	Representational State Transfer
RF	Random Forest
ROC	Receiver Operating Characteristic
SA	Simulated Annealing
SDG	Sustainable Development Goal
SHAP	SHapley Additive exPlanations
SOS	Emergency distress request
UI	User Interface
WS	WebSocket
XAI	Explainable Artificial Intelligence
XGBoost	eXtreme Gradient Boosting

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background of the Project

Floods affect more people in India than any other natural hazard. Monsoon rainfall, upstream reservoir releases and rapid urbanisation combine to produce events in which river stage, road accessibility and shelter demand all change within hours. The Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015 to 2030 stresses that early warning is useful only when it leads to early action, and the United Nations 2030 Agenda lists resilience to climate-related hazards as an explicit development goal.

Recent work has made data-driven flood forecasting practical. Global machine-learning models now issue reliable forecasts for extreme floods even in ungauged basins [1], and large Indian datasets such as INDOFLOODS [6] and CAMELS-IND [7] make it possible to train and evaluate models on Indian catchments. In parallel, digital twins, which are continuously updated virtual replicas of physical systems [8], and large language model agents [24] are being explored as decision-support layers for emergency management.

AquaSentinel brings these strands together in one working prototype. It is a full-stack web platform for the Delhi Yamuna corridor and five major Indian dams that senses live conditions, predicts flood risk, reasons through a graph of cooperating agents, decides on an action under explicit safety gates, optimises shelters and routes, and coordinates the rescue response, and it runs exactly the same pipeline on synthetic scenarios as a digital twin.

1.2 Problem Statement

During a flood, emergency operators must answer several connected questions at once: How likely is flooding in the next few days? Is the risk high enough to evacuate automatically, or should a human review it? Which shelters are safe and still have space? Which roads are open, and what is the fastest safe route? Which of many simultaneous SOS calls should be served first, and by which team?

Existing tools typically answer one of these questions in isolation. Forecast portals show water levels but do not plan evacuations. Routing tools ignore flood exposure. Dashboards often show static or decorative numbers that are not tied to any live state. The problem addressed by this project is to build a single, auditable system in which every displayed value, such as risk, route, shelter and rescue progress, is computed from one authoritative

state, and in which the path from sensor reading to rescue dispatch is transparent and testable.

1.3 Motivation

The motivation comes from three observations. First, recurring floods on the Yamuna in Delhi and in reservoir-fed basins such as the Krishna and Mahanadi show that the decision window is short, so operators benefit from automation that is safe by design rather than automation that acts silently. Second, machine-learning flood models are often reported with optimistic accuracy on random splits that leak information between gauges. We wanted a model whose performance is measured on gauges and years it has never seen. Third, emergency services increasingly expect natural-language interfaces. A voice SOS agent that asks only for the caller's name lowers the barrier for people in distress.

1.4 Objectives

1. To ingest live weather, rainfall and river-stage data, normalise it, and label every value with its real source or an explicit "data unavailable" state.
2. To train flood models with group- and time-aware validation, without target leakage, and to serve them with SHAP explanations of the model that actually produced each prediction.
3. To design a gated decision policy with the actions MONITOR, HUMAN REVIEW and AUTOMATED RESPONSE, configurable thresholds and an auditable operator review step.
4. To coordinate seven agents through a shared event graph that is persisted in MongoDB and streamed to the user interface over WebSocket.
5. To compute shelter assignments and evacuation routes from the current road state using Dijkstra, A*, Yen's k-shortest paths and QUBO-based optimisation.
6. To manage concurrent SOS requests with K-means clustering, vulnerable-first ordering and a per-person rescue stage machine driven by real route travel times.
7. To provide a digital twin and a dam monitor that reuse the same pipeline on synthetic scenarios, and to benchmark constraint-aware evacuation routing reproducibly.

1.5 Scope of the Project

The project covers the complete software system: data ingestion, model training and inference, risk and policy engines, agents, optimisation, rescue operations, simulation, a React dashboard, automated tests and Docker deployment. The operational geography is the Delhi NCR Yamuna corridor, which includes the Yamuna at ITO, the Hathnikund and Okhla barrages, five public-facility shelters and rescue staging points, together with five dams: Mettur, Srisailam, Nagarjuna Sagar, Hirakud and Bhakra.

The following are outside the scope. The system does not call authenticated India-WRIS or CWC gauge APIs and therefore never invents official gauge readings. Live traffic is represented by a curated road graph with runtime blockage flags rather than a commercial traffic feed. The QAOA solver is a quantum-inspired classical simulation, not execution on quantum hardware, and no quantum speed-up is claimed. The system is a research prototype and has not been deployed in a real emergency.

2. LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction

This chapter reviews the literature that informs each layer of AquaSentinel: data-driven flood forecasting, explainable machine learning, Indian flood datasets, digital twins for flood management, evacuation routing and optimisation, including classical, reinforcement-learning and quantum-inspired methods, and large-language-model agents for disaster response. For each area we note the techniques used and the limitations that motivate the design choices of this project.

2.2 Review of Related Studies

2.2.1 Data-driven flood forecasting

Mosavi, Ozturk and Chau [5] surveyed machine-learning flood prediction models and found that ensemble and hybrid methods consistently outperform single models, but also that many studies evaluate on short records and random splits, which makes their accuracy hard to transfer to new catchments. This observation directly shaped our validation design, in which test gauges are never seen during training.

Nearing et al. [1] showed in Nature that a machine-learning model trained on thousands of gauges can forecast extreme riverine floods in ungauged watersheds with reliability comparable to, or better than, a state-of-the-art physical system at lead times of several days. Their work demonstrates that large-sample training generalises across basins, which is the premise of our version-4 model trained on 242 Indian gauges.

Kirschstein and Sun [2] tested whether graph neural networks benefit from explicit river-network topology when forecasting discharge at many gauging stations, and found that the GNNs did not gain from the topology information and struggled with sudden discharge spikes. Wang et al. [3] argued that the tree-like structure of river networks causes over-squashing in GNNs, and showed that a reachability-based graph transformation extended the useful forecast horizon by about ten hours relative to an EA-LSTM baseline. Pan, Mohammadi and Taylor [4] combined a graph convolutional recurrent network with residual error learning for 1 to 6 hour streamflow forecasting and reported gains over common baselines. Together these studies show that deep models are promising but that gauge-level features such as recent flow and rainfall remain the strongest predictors, which are the features our gradient boosted model relies on.

2.2.2 Gradient boosting, random forests and explainability

Random forests [10] average many decorrelated decision trees and are robust to noisy tabular features. XGBoost [11] adds regularised second-order gradient boosting with efficient sparse handling, LightGBM uses histogram-based leaf-wise growth for speed on large datasets, and CatBoost uses ordered boosting to reduce prediction shift with categorical features. All four families are used in this project and compared under identical splits. The scikit-learn library provides the common training and evaluation framework.

For explanation, Lundberg and Lee [12] unified several attribution methods under Shapley values, known as SHAP, and Lundberg et al. [13] introduced TreeSHAP, which computes exact Shapley values for tree ensembles in polynomial time. Such explanations can reveal when a model relies on spurious location signals, which is why AquaSentinel computes SHAP from the same booster that produced each displayed probability rather than from a surrogate model.

Liu, Ting and Zhou [14] proposed the Isolation Forest, which isolates anomalies with random partitions and needs no density model. We use it to flag abrupt jumps in rainfall, river level, dam level and flood probability on the command-centre cards.

2.2.3 Indian flood datasets

Kuntla and Saharia [6] released INDOFLOODS, an observational database of Indian flood events built by combining long-term station discharge with official warning and danger levels. Each event carries its start and end, peak level and discharge, volume, duration, time to peak and recession time, and is enriched with geomorphological, climatological, land-cover, soil and anthropogenic catchment attributes. AquaSentinel's version-1 to version-3 models are trained on INDOFLOODS.

Mangukiya et al. [7] published CAMELS-IND, which provides daily hydrometeorological time series and catchment attributes for catchments in Peninsular India. Because it contains daily observed streamflow alongside rainfall, temperature, evapotranspiration and soil moisture, it supports a true forecasting task, namely predicting whether flow will exceed a flood threshold in the next three days, which is the task of our version-4 model.

2.2.4 Digital twins for flood management

Grieves and Vickers [8] defined the digital twin as a virtual representation that mirrors a physical system through its life cycle and can be used to anticipate undesirable emergent behaviour. Underhill, McEwen and Coulthard [9] reported on the co-design of an

environmental digital twin with flood-risk management professionals and found that practitioners value transparency, trust in data provenance and the ability to explore alternative scenarios more than visual realism. These findings support two design rules of this project: every value shown must trace to the current simulation state, and simulated data must always be labelled as simulation.

2.2.5 Evacuation routing and optimisation

Dijkstra's algorithm [15] computes single-source shortest paths on graphs with non-negative weights, A* adds an admissible heuristic to focus the search, and Yen's algorithm [16] enumerates the k shortest loopless paths, giving operators alternatives when the best road closes. The NetworkX library provides tested implementations of these algorithms for the road graph used in this project.

Kirkpatrick, Gelatt and Vecchi [17] introduced simulated annealing for combinatorial optimisation, and Lucas [18] showed how many NP-hard problems, including assignment and routing problems, can be written as Ising or QUBO models. Farhi, Goldstone and Gutmann [19] proposed the Quantum Approximate Optimization Algorithm, known as QAOA, a variational method that alternates cost and mixer operators. Cadeliña et al. [20] applied D-Wave quantum annealing to a QUBO formulation of vehicle routing for disaster-response resource allocation in Marikina City and reported improved distribution of resources. We follow the same QUBO modelling approach for zone-to-shelter assignment but run a classical simulation of QAOA and compare it honestly with greedy and simulated-annealing solvers.

2.2.6 Reinforcement learning for evacuation

Schulman et al. [21] introduced Proximal Policy Optimization, known as PPO, a stable policy-gradient method widely used in control problems. Liu et al. [22] coupled storm surge models ADCIRC and SWAN with a deep Q-network to plan evacuation of a petrochemical industrial zone, and Raei, Safarzadeh and Wang [23] proposed congestion-aware multi-agent reinforcement learning for wildfire evacuation in which each intersection is an independent agent that balances efficiency against hazard avoidance. A common concern in these studies is that a learned policy may still select an unsafe route. Our HQRL module therefore places a hard QUBO constraint layer and a deterministic validation checklist after the RL candidate generator.

2.2.7 LLM agents for disaster response

Xu et al. [24] reviewed 70 studies on large language models in disaster management and proposed a framework built on multi-modal data fusion, multi-source validation and multi-agent collaboration. In AquaSentinel, LLMs are used only for narration in the agent radio and for the voice SOS front end. The decisions themselves come from deterministic, testable code.

2.3 Techniques and Technologies Used in Existing Systems

Table 2.1 Summary of techniques in the reviewed literature

Area	Representative techniques	Studies
Flood forecasting	Large-sample ML, LSTM, GNN, graph convolutional RNN and ML review	[1], [2], [3], [4], [5]
Tabular ML	Random forest and XGBoost, with LightGBM and CatBoost also compared	[10], [11]
Explainability	SHAP, TreeSHAP	[12], [13]
Anomaly detection	Isolation Forest	[14]
Datasets	INDOFLOODS, CAMELS-IND	[6], [7]
Digital twin	Virtual replica, co-designed environmental twin	[8], [9]
Routing	Dijkstra, A*, Yen k-shortest paths	[15], [16]
Optimisation	Simulated annealing, QUBO, QAOA and quantum annealing	[17], [18], [19], [20]
RL evacuation	PPO, DQN, multi-agent RL	[21], [22], [23]
LLM agents	LLM review of disaster management	[24]
Weather and flood data	Open-Meteo forecast and flood APIs	[25]

2.4 Research Gap

The review reveals the following gaps that this project addresses:

- Forecasting studies rarely connect the probability to an operational decision, a shelter plan and a rescue dispatch in one system.
- Many reported flood-model accuracies use random row splits. Few studies evaluate on unseen gauges and later years, which is how a deployed model is actually used.
- Explanations are frequently produced by a surrogate model rather than the model that made the displayed prediction.
- RL evacuation planners optimise speed but do not always enforce hard constraints such as closed roads and shelter capacity.

- Quantum-optimisation studies often claim advantage without a like-for-like classical baseline on the same instances.
- Dashboards and digital twins often show static or decorative values. Practitioners ask for provenance and clearly labelled simulation [9].

2.5 Summary

Machine-learning flood forecasting, explainable boosting models, graph search, QUBO optimisation, reinforcement learning and LLM agents are each mature enough to use, but they are rarely combined into a single auditable pipeline with honest evaluation. AquaSentinel is designed to close this gap: one shared pipeline, group- and time-aware model validation, explanations from the serving model, hard safety constraints after any learned component, and a digital twin that never presents simulated data as live.

3. NEED FOR PROPOSED TECHNIQUE

3.1 Existing Techniques

Threshold-based warning from gauge levels. Agencies compare the observed water level at a station with fixed warning and danger levels. The method is simple and trusted, but it is reactive: an alert is raised only when the river is already high, and it gives no guidance on shelters or routes.

Physical hydrological and hydraulic models. Rainfall runoff and river-routing models simulate flow and inundation from physics. They are accurate when calibrated, but they need detailed inputs, are computationally heavy and are usually run by specialists rather than embedded in an operations dashboard.

Stand-alone machine-learning forecasts. Models such as random forests, gradient boosting and LSTMs predict flood occurrence or level from rainfall and catchment features [5]. They are fast, but many are validated with random splits, provide no explanation, and stop at a probability.

GIS dashboards and static evacuation plans. Pre-computed evacuation maps and dashboards show shelters and roads, but routes are not recomputed when a road floods or a shelter fills, and the displayed numbers are often not tied to live state.

Learned routing policies. Reinforcement-learning planners [22], [23] adapt to changing conditions but may choose unsafe routes when the reward does not encode every constraint.

3.2 Limitations of Existing Techniques

- Fragmentation: forecasting, decision, shelter planning, routing and rescue are separate tools, so operators reconcile them manually.
- Optimistic evaluation: random splits leak gauge identity and give accuracy that does not hold on new rivers or years.
- Opaque predictions: probabilities are shown without a faithful explanation of what drove them.
- Unsafe or silent automation: there is no explicit gate that stops automatic action when data, the model or the database is unhealthy.
- Static plans: routes and shelter choices do not react to blockages or capacity changes.

- No safe rehearsal: there is rarely a digital twin that runs the same logic on scenarios, so plans cannot be tested before a real event.

3.3 Proposed Technique

We propose an agentic, state driven pipeline in which a single function, the shared pipeline, executes the steps Sense, Predict, Reason, Decide, Optimize and Respond for both live and simulation modes. Only the data provider changes. The key elements are:

- A hybrid operational risk engine that keeps the trained model as a prior and adds documented rainfall and stage-versus-danger terms, so risk rises monotonically with the hazard.
- A gated decision policy with a configurable monitor threshold of 0.50 and an automatic threshold of 0.60, together with data quality, model and database health gates.
- A seven-agent event graph whose events are stored in MongoDB and streamed over WebSocket.
- Flood-aware routing with Dijkstra, A* and Yen, and QUBO-based zone-to-shelter assignment solved by greedy, simulated annealing and a QAOA-inspired solver.
- K-means SOS clustering with vulnerable-first ordering and a per-person rescue stage machine whose stage durations equal route travel times.
- A constraint aware HQRL routing benchmark that passes through PPO candidates, QUBO constraints, a solver, validation and explanation.
- A version-4 XGBoost 3-day flood forecast trained on CAMELS-IND with unseen-gauge testing and TreeSHAP explanations.

3.4 Objectives of the Proposed Technique

The proposed technique addresses each limitation directly. Fragmentation is removed because one pipeline produces the probability, the decision, the shelter plan, the routes and the rescue state, and every screen reads from that state. Optimistic evaluation is avoided by GroupShuffleSplit and GroupKFold by gauge for the v2 and v3 INDOFLOODS models and by a gauge- and time-separated split for CAMELS-IND. Opaque predictions are replaced by TreeSHAP computed on the serving model. Silent automation is prevented by the gates in the decision engine: if any gate fails, an automated response is downgraded to human review and the reason is recorded. Static plans are replaced by routes recomputed

from the current road state at dispatch and again at pickup. Finally, the digital twin allows every scenario to be rehearsed with the same code.

3.5 Advantages of the Proposed Technique

- End-to-end traceability: every displayed value traces to one authoritative state and every decision is audit-logged.
- Honest, reproducible evaluation: metrics are read from evaluation files produced by the training scripts, and benchmarks use fixed seeds.
- Safety by construction: hard constraints and health gates sit after every learned or heuristic component.
- Adaptivity: routes and assignments are recomputed when roads block or shelters fill.
- Explainability: SHAP contributions, policy rules and validation checklists explain why an action was chosen.
- Accessibility: a voice SOS agent asks only for the caller's name, and the dashboard works in light and dark themes.
- Portability: the whole stack runs locally or on a VPS with docker compose.

4. DESIGN OF PROPOSED SYSTEM AND ITS IMPLEMENTATION

4.1 Introduction

This chapter describes the design and implementation of AquaSentinel: the hardware and software requirements, the layered architecture, the modules, the methodology and workflow, the algorithms, the datasets and preprocessing, model development, design diagrams, the code organisation and the user interface.

4.2 System Requirements

The system was developed and tested on a single laptop and is packaged with Docker so that it can run on any Linux VPS. Requirements are listed below.

4.2.1 Hardware Requirements

Table 4.1 Hardware requirements

Component	Development machine used	Minimum recommended
Processor	Intel Core i5-1135G7 at 2.40 GHz, 11th Gen	4-core x86-64 CPU
Memory, RAM	8 GB, 7.7 GB usable	8 GB, or 16 GB for v4 retraining
Graphics	Intel Iris Xe, integrated	Not required, CPU-only training
Storage	SSD	10 GB free for datasets, models and Docker images
Network	Broadband Internet	Internet access for weather and flood APIs
Client	Any modern browser	Chrome, Edge or Firefox, with a microphone for voice SOS

4.2.2 Software Requirements

Table 4.2 Software requirements

Layer	Software and library	Purpose
Operating system	Windows 11 for development and Linux VPS for deployment	Host platform
Frontend	React 19.1, React DOM, React Router 7.8, Vite 7.1	Single-page application and build tool
Maps and charts	Leaflet 1.9, React-Leaflet 5.0, Recharts 3.1	Flood and rescue maps and time-series charts
HTTP client	Axios 1.11, native WebSocket	REST calls and live updates
Backend	Python 3.11 or later, FastAPI 0.115 or later, Uvicorn, Pydantic 2	REST and WebSocket API with validation
Database	MongoDB 7, Motor 3.6 or later, PyMongo 4.10 or later	Asynchronous persistence of state and audit logs

Layer	Software and library	Purpose
Machine learning	scikit-learn 1.6 or later, XGBoost 2.1 or later, LightGBM 4.0 or later, CatBoost 1.2 or later, joblib	Training and inference
Data and XAI	pandas 2.2 or later, NumPy 2.0 or later, SHAP 0.46 or later	Feature engineering and explanations
Graphs	NetworkX 3.0 or later	Road graph, Dijkstra, A* and k-shortest paths
Security	python-jose for JWT, passlib with bcrypt, SlowAPI	Operator login, hashing, rate limiting
Reporting	fpdf2 2.8 or later	After-action PDF report
External services	Open-Meteo, OpenWeather as an option, Groq LLM, Google Gemini	Weather, flood discharge, agent radio, voice SOS
Testing	pytest, pytest-asyncio, Vitest 3.2, Testing Library, jsdom	Backend and frontend tests
Deployment	Docker, docker compose, nginx	Containers and reverse proxy

4.3 System Architecture

AquaSentinel follows a five layer architecture, shown in Figure 4.1. The presentation layer is a React single page application with four screens. It talks to the backend through REST endpoints and a WebSocket hub that pushes typed events such as weather, risk, agent, route, rescue and simulation updates, together with heartbeats.

The application layer is a FastAPI service. Twelve routers for health, live data, machine learning, agents, response, simulation, HQRL, emergency, sources, the rescue desk, the voice agent and dams expose the functionality. At its centre is the shared pipeline that runs for both live and simulation modes. It covers data normalisation, the feature engine, ML prediction, the operational risk engine, the decision policy and the agent graph, followed by the shelter engine, route engine, QUBO optimiser, SOS clustering and the rescue stage machine. A background task runs the live pipeline every 90 seconds. Live and simulation snapshots are stored separately so that synthetic ticks can never appear as live intelligence.

The data layer holds the MongoDB collections for observations, agent events, incidents, policy and review audit logs, rescue teams, shelters and benchmark results, together with the trained model artefacts, evaluation files and the training datasets, which are never used as live telemetry. External sources are Open-Meteo for weather and river discharge, OpenWeather when a key is configured, OpenStreetMap tiles, and the Groq and Gemini LLM APIs. All API keys stay in a server-side environment file, and the browser talks only to the backend.

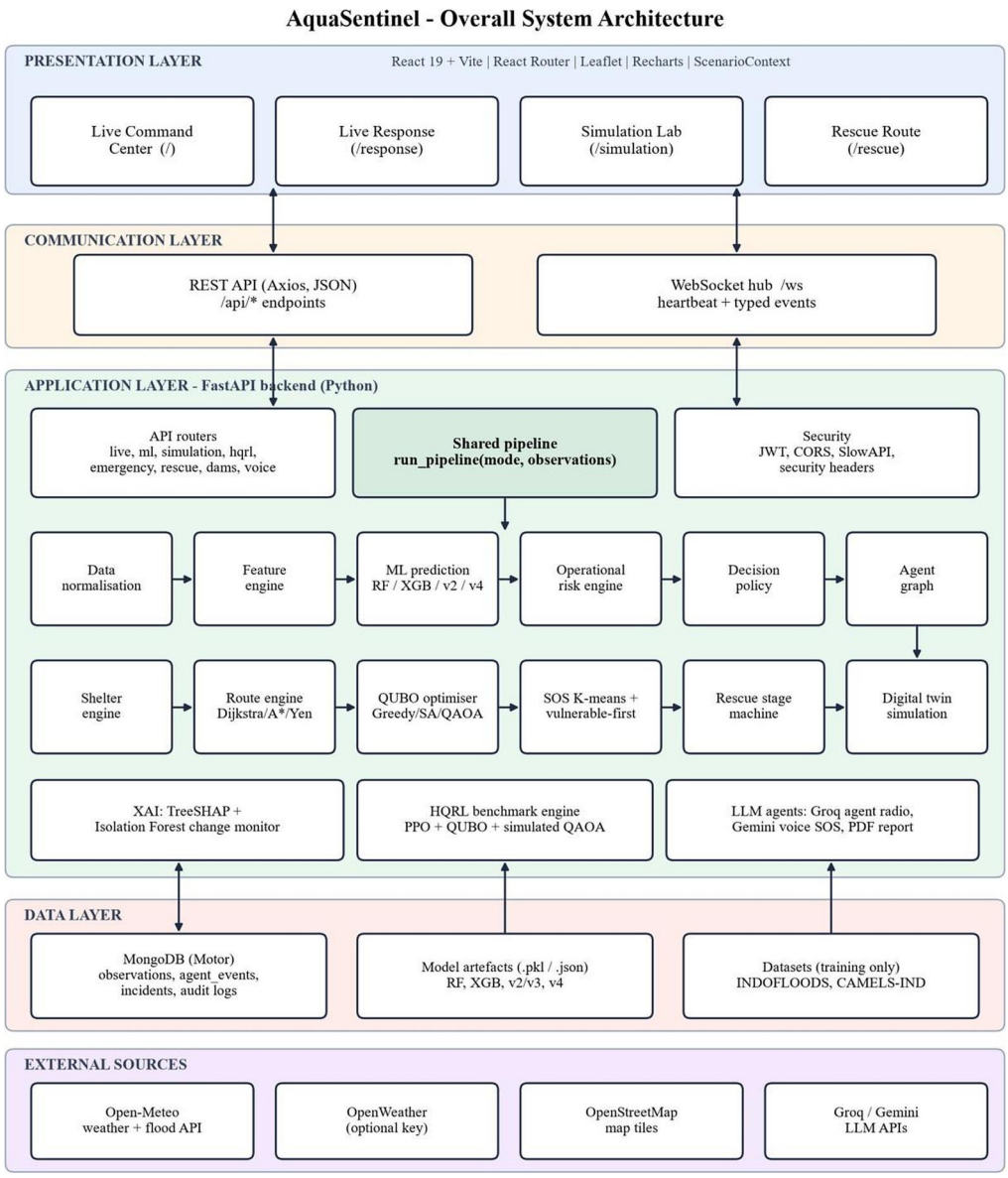


Figure 4.1 Overall system architecture of AquaSentinel

4.4 System Components and Modules

The system is organised into ten modules. Each module lives in its own package or file, so it can be tested in isolation.

4.4.1 Module 1: Live Data Ingestion

The weather service fetches current conditions, 24 hour rainfall and a 10 day precipitation forecast for Delhi. OpenWeather is used when an OpenWeather key is set. Otherwise Open-Meteo is used without a key [25]. The hydrology service calls the Open-Meteo Flood API for river discharge at Yamuna at ITO, Hathnikund Barrage and Okhla Barrage and maps it onto the configured danger level of 205.80 m. If every provider fails the service returns DATA SOURCE UNAVAILABLE instead of inventing values, and each observation is stored with its source label.

4.4.2 Module 2: Flood Prediction Using Machine Learning

The inference module loads the model artefacts once at start up. Version 1 provides a Random Forest and an XGBoost classifier for severe floods on INDOFLOODS. A dual model view compares both and flags disagreement above the shared gap threshold of 0.15. Versions 2 and 3 form a two stage model: a LightGBM peak flood level regressor, tail weighted in version 3, followed by a CatBoost severe flood classifier. Version 4 is the XGBoost 3 day flood forecast trained on CAMELS-IND. Because no live observed gauge feed is available, it is served as a historical replay on real gauge days, returning the probability, what actually happened in the next three days and the TreeSHAP contributions from the same booster.

4.4.3 Module 3: Operational Risk and Decision Policy

The operational risk engine produces the probability used by the policy. The decision engine maps that probability to an action using one shared set of thresholds, which is the single source of truth and is served through the configuration endpoint. The policy is described in Section 4.7.

4.4.4 Module 4: Multi-Agent Coordination

The agent graph holds seven agents, each with a memory that stores its status, last event, current action, timestamp and state. Every event is written as a document in MongoDB and broadcast as an agent update over WebSocket. Table 4.3 lists the agents.

Table 4.3 Agents in the agent graph

Agent	Input	Output event
Weather	Live or simulated weather	Weather update
Dam	River and dam observations	Dam update
Flood Risk	ML and operational probability	Flood risk update, decision required
Traffic	Road flood exposure vs probability	Blocked road set
Shelter	Capacity, risk and distance	Shelter search
Evacuation	Policy, routes and QUBO assignment	Route optimization, evacuation plan
Rescue	SOS and automatic response	Rescue response, SOS

An agent radio layer turns threshold crossings into short spoken style messages between the Rescue, Ambulance, Disaster Team and Administrator agents using Groq hosted LLMs. The LLM only narrates and never changes a decision.

4.4.5 Module 5: Shelter, Route and Optimisation

The shelter engine filters out shelters that are unsafe, closed, full, inaccessible or at a flood risk of 0.65 or more, or 0.45 or more when the zone risk is at least 0.7, and then scores the rest by distance, free seats, traffic and risk. The route engine builds a weighted graph of Delhi road nodes, removes blocked edges and computes flood-aware routes. The optimiser assigns population zones to shelters as a QUBO problem and solves it with four methods, namely greedy, a Dijkstra proxy, simulated annealing and a QAOA-inspired solver, and the user interface always shows the method actually used. An Algorithm Arena compares Dijkstra by distance only, Dijkstra flood-aware, A* flood-aware and greedy straight-line routing for every SOS.

4.4.6 Module 6: SOS Triage and Rescue Operations

Concurrent SOS requests are clustered with K-means, and clusters are matched to rescue teams by minimising people-weighted distance, using an exhaustive permutation search when there are at most seven teams. Within the queue, people are ordered vulnerable-first, with children under 12 years and elderly people aged 60 years and above first, followed by water depth, with chest, neck and shoulder depth before waist depth. The rescue stage machine, shown in Figure 4.3, moves each person through the stages queued, assigned, en route, to shelter and rescued, with stage durations equal to real route travel times. The rescue desk manages ten ambulance units and five shelters with about 10,000 places in total.

4.4.7 Module 7: Digital Twin Simulation and Dam Monitor

The simulation engine evolves a scenario tick by tick: rainfall rises, river and dam stage rise, ML probability updates, roads with high flood exposure block, shelter occupancy grows and SOS count rises. Each tick calls the shared pipeline in simulation mode, so the twin uses exactly the same logic as live mode, and every simulation screen is labelled as simulation mode with synthetic data. The Dam Monitor covers Mettur on the Cauvery, Srisailam and Nagarjuna Sagar on the Krishna, Hirakud on the Mahanadi and Bhakra on the Sutlej. It computes live storage fill as the level minus dead storage, divided by the full reservoir level minus dead storage, maps fill to the bands MODERATE at 50 percent or more, HIGH at 70 percent or more, VERY HIGH at 85 percent or more and CRITICAL at 95 percent or more, and to the responses MONITOR, ALERT, PREPARE EVACUATION and EVACUATE, and runs a bounded water balance simulation. The scenario catalogue offers dam scenarios such as normal operation, heavy rainfall, extreme rainfall, emergency

release, worst case inflow and drought or low inflow, simulation scenarios such as road blockage, shelter congestion and multiple SOS surge, and two HQRL benchmark scenarios.

4.4.8 Module 8: HQRL Evacuation Benchmark

The HQRL engine is a synthetic research prototype for constraint aware evacuation routing on a graph of 15 nodes with six population groups and three shelters. A PPO style policy proposes the top K route candidates. A QUBO encodes hard constraints such as road closures, shelter capacity, vehicle availability and accessibility. A simulated QAOA solver, with a classical QUBO fallback, selects the plan, a deterministic validation checklist confirms it, and an XAI panel explains each accept or reject decision. A human in the loop gate holds automatic dispatch when data sources conflict. The engine benchmarks six methods over fixed seed scenarios and runs an ablation without the safety layer, as shown in Figure 4.4.

4.4.9 Module 9: Voice SOS and LLM Agent Radio

The voice agent uses Google Gemini with a single tool that submits the flood SOS. The agent asks only for the caller's full name. Location comes from the device and other fields use defaults. When the name is known the tool registers the SOS, assigns the nearest available team and a shelter, and the agent reads back the assignment in English.

4.4.10 Module 10: Frontend Dashboard

The React application has four routes. The Live Command Center, at the root route, shows live weather, hydrology, ML and operational flood probability, agents, the map and measured latencies. Live Response shows incidents, the policy decision with approve and reject controls, shelters, routes and optimisation. The Simulation Lab holds the scenario picker, inputs, the single RUN SCENARIO flow, the Dam Monitor, the ML benchmark and the HQRL benchmark, and its state is owned by a shared scenario context. Rescue Route shows the live rescue map with animated units, the live SOS roster and the event feed. Map icons are cached and units are animated with one shared animation loop so the map stays smooth while the page re-renders every 1.2 seconds.

4.5 Proposed Methodology

1. Data acquisition: collect live weather, rainfall and river discharge from Open-Meteo, and from OpenWeather if configured, and load INDOFLOODS and CAMELS-IND for training only.

2. Preprocessing and features: clean the data, remove leakage columns, build rainfall-accumulation, flow-ratio, soil-moisture, seasonal and catchment features.
3. Model training and selection: train candidate models with group- and time-aware splits, choose on validation, and evaluate once on unseen gauges.
4. Risk estimation: combine the model prior with rainfall and stage-versus-danger terms in the operational risk engine.
5. Decision: apply the gated policy to choose MONITOR, HUMAN REVIEW or AUTOMATED RESPONSE. Log operator reviews.
6. Coordination: let the agent graph emit events and stream them to the UI.
7. Optimisation: filter and score shelters, compute flood-aware routes and solve the QUBO assignment.
8. Response: cluster SOS calls, order them vulnerable-first and run the rescue stage machine.
9. Rehearsal and evaluation: run the same pipeline on digital-twin scenarios and benchmark algorithms with fixed seeds.

4.6 System Workflow

Figure 4.2 shows the workflow of one pipeline cycle. A cycle starts from the live ticker or a simulation tick, senses the environment, builds features, predicts risk, checks the health gates, lets the agents reason, decides on an action, optimises shelters and routes, responds by dispatching teams and pushing updates to the UI, and finally stores the snapshot and audit log.

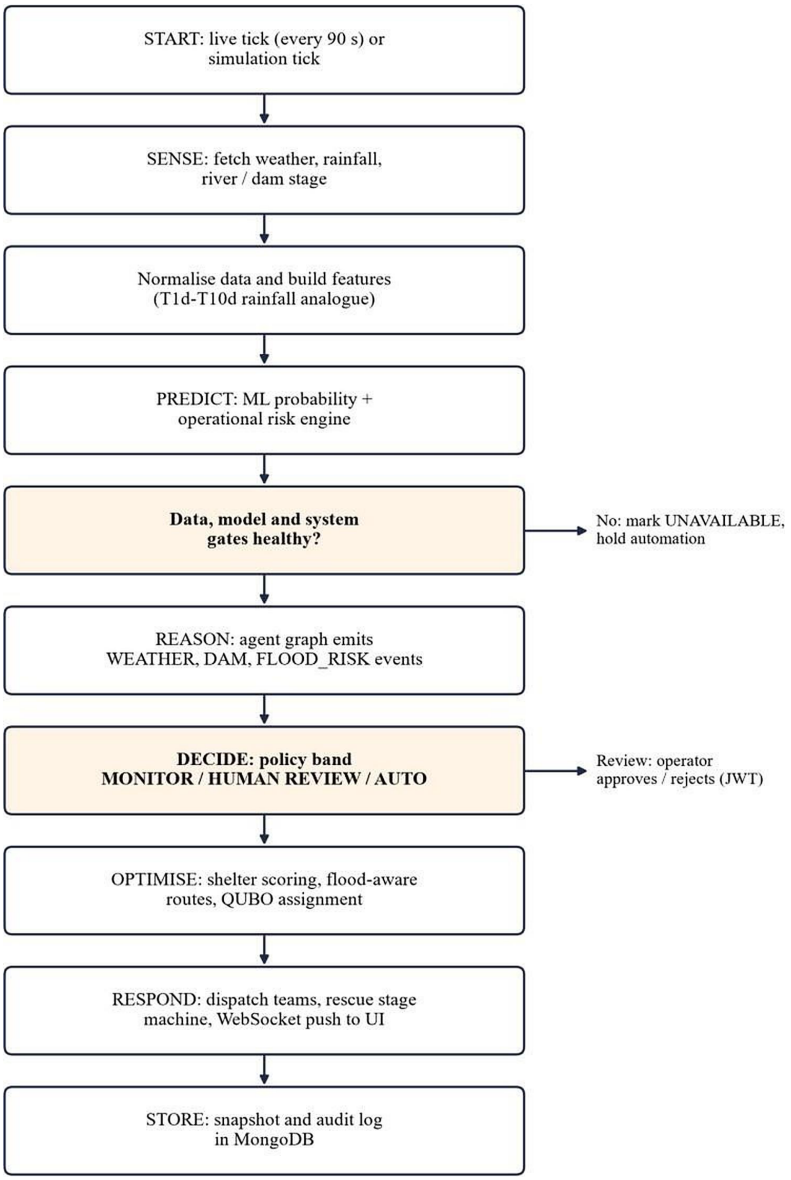


Figure 4.2 Workflow of one pipeline cycle

4.7 Algorithms and Techniques Used

4.7.1 Operational Risk Engine

The INDOFLOODS severe-versus-flood label is largely a station property, so the trained classifier barely changes with rainfall. The operational risk engine therefore keeps the ML score as a prior and adds hazard terms that must increase as the hazard increases:

$$p = clip(\, 0.16 + 0.50 \cdot \sigma_{rain} + 0.20 \cdot h_{stage} + 0.14 \cdot p_{ML} \,,\, 0 \,,\, 1 \,)$$

$$\sigma_{rain} = 1 / (1 + exp(-(R - 38) / 12)), \quad h_{stage} = mean(\, clip((pct - 70) / 30, 0, 1) \,)$$

where R is the 24-hour rainfall in mm and pct is the river or dam stage as a percentage of its danger level. The coefficients are documented project settings, not a claim of extra ML accuracy, and the engine is tested to be monotonic in rainfall.

4.7.2 Gated Decision Policy

If the probability is unavailable, the action is unavailable. If an operator override is active, the action is human override. Otherwise, a probability below 0.50 gives monitor, a probability from 0.50 up to but not including 0.60 gives human review, and a probability of 0.60 or more gives automated response, but only if automation is enabled and the data quality, model and database gates all pass. If they do not, the action is downgraded to human review with the reason safety gate blocked automation. Severity labels use 0.35 for moderate, 0.50 for high and 0.70 for critical.

4.7.3 Flood-Aware Routing

Each road edge between two nodes receives a cost that inflates its length by traffic and flood exposure, and blocked or inaccessible edges are removed. The cost is given by the following expression:

$$cost(u, v) = d_{uv} \cdot (1 + 0.8 \cdot traffic + 1.4 \cdot flood_{exposure})$$

Travel time is the cost divided by a rescue speed of 25 km per hour. Dijkstra's algorithm [15] returns the cheapest path, A* uses the haversine distance to the destination as heuristic, and Yen's algorithm [16] provides alternative routes.

4.7.4 QUBO Zone-to-Shelter Assignment

Let $x_{ij} = 1$ if zone i is assigned to shelter j. The cost of each pair is

$$c_{ij} = 0.30 \cdot travel + 0.25 \cdot distance + 0.20 \cdot (8 \cdot flood_risk_j) + 0.10 \cdot (5 \cdot traffic) + 0.15 \cdot overload_{ij}$$

and penalties enforce one shelter per zone, shelter capacity and the exclusion of unsafe shelters [18]. The greedy solver picks the cheapest feasible column per zone. Simulated annealing [17] searches reassignments. The QAOA-inspired solver [19] runs variational cost and mixer phases over one-hot bitstrings on a classical simulator. Runtime, cost, distance, evacuation time, risk exposure, utilisation and constraint violations are recorded for each method.

4.7.5 SOS Clustering and Vulnerable-First Ordering

K-means with ten initialisations and a fixed random seed of 42 groups SOS locations, and clusters are matched to teams by minimum people weighted distance. A vulnerability tier that places children and elderly people first, and a water depth tier, then order the dispatch queue. One SOS is dispatched every 3 wall clock seconds, crews take 2 seconds to mobilise, and the demo clock runs 120 times faster than real time, so one second equals two simulated minutes.

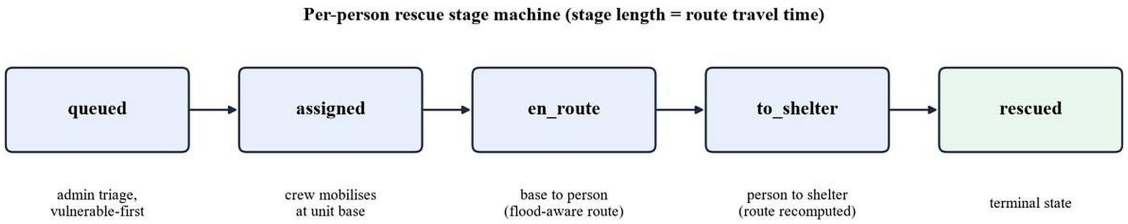


Figure 4.3 Per-person rescue stage machine

4.7.6 HQRL Constraint-Aware Routing

Figure 4.4 shows the HQRL pipeline. The policy [21] proposes candidate routes. The QUBO layer removes candidates that use closed roads, exceed shelter capacity, lack vehicles or violate accessibility. The solver selects among the remaining candidates, and the validation checklist must pass before a recommendation is shown. The checklist covers route presence, road status, shelter capacity, vehicle availability, accessibility, priority constraints, graph version and data freshness.

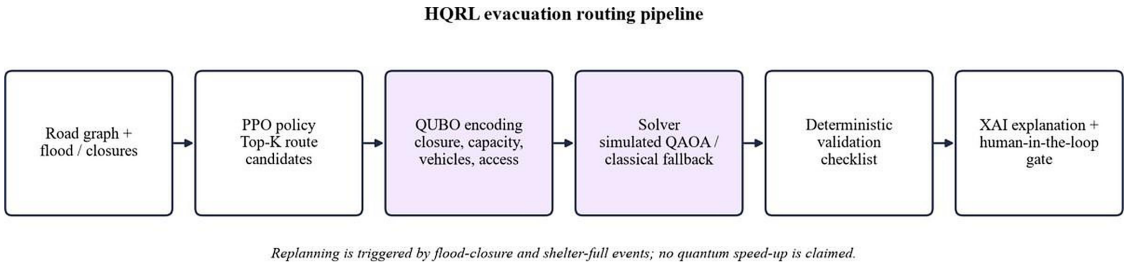


Figure 4.4 HQRL constraint-aware evacuation routing pipeline

4.7.7 Explainability and Change Monitoring

TreeSHAP [13] is computed on the Random Forest, on the version 2 regressor and on the version 4 XGBoost booster in log-odds units, always on the model that produced the displayed number. An Isolation Forest [14] with 40 trees and a contamination of 0.12, together with a rate-of-change rule, flags sudden jumps in rainfall, river level, dam level and flood probability.

4.8 Dataset and Data Collection

Table 4.4 Datasets used for training and evaluation

Dataset	Contents	Use in the project
INDOFLOODS [6]	4,548 flood events, of which 2,919 are Flood and 1,629 are Severe Flood, with event-scale precipitation for 1 to 10 days and catchment characteristics	v1 Random Forest and XGBoost severe flood classifiers, and the v2 and v3 peak level regressor and classifier
CAMELS-IND [7]	Daily rainfall, temperature, humidity, evapotranspiration, four-layer soil moisture and observed streamflow with catchment attributes, using 242 gauges	v4 3-day flood forecast (production model)
Open-Meteo, live	Current weather, 24-h rainfall, 10-day forecast, river discharge	Live inference only, never used for training
Curated geography	Delhi road graph, 5 shelters, rescue staging points, 5 dams	Routing, shelter assignment, Dam Monitor

Two other files in the dataset folder, one with state level daily rainfall and one India weather workbook, were examined and excluded because they share no gauge, coordinate or state key with the INDOFLOODS catchment table.

4.9 Data Preprocessing

- Leakage removal: columns describing the outcome of an event are excluded, namely the peak flood level date, number of peaks, peak discharge and its date, flood volume, event duration, time to peak and recession time.
- Group leakage removal: gauge identity, per-gauge priors and per-gauge z-scores were dropped after v1 so that the models generalise to unseen catchments.
- Rainfall features for INDOFLOODS: cumulative rainfall over one to ten days, log transforms, month, day of year, monsoon flag, recent intensity and build up ratios.
- Forecast features for CAMELS-IND, 50 in total: lagged rainfall from zero to three days, rainfall sums over 3, 7, 14, 30 and 90 days, 7 day maximum, temperature, humidity, potential and actual evapotranspiration, soil moisture in four layers and their changes, flow ratios to the gauge flood level including lags, changes, 7 and 30 day means and the 7 day peak, log flow, seasonal sine and cosine terms and static catchment attributes.
- Target for v4: a value of 1 if observed streamflow reaches the gauge's training period 95th percentile on any of the next three days.
- Splits: version 1 was scored on a held-out set of 910 events and still contained gauge identity, so it is treated only as an optimistic baseline. Versions 2 and 3 use

an 80 to 20 GroupShuffleSplit by gauge, giving 3,760 training and 788 test events from 124 and 31 gauges, together with five-fold GroupKFold by gauge. Version 4 trains on seen gauges from 1980 to 2008, validates on 2009 to 2014 and tests on 20 percent unseen gauges from 2015 to 2020.

- Excluded from version 4: CAMELS hydrological signatures computed over the full record, since they include test years, and any future rainfall.

4.10 Model and System Development

Models were trained with the training scripts in the scripts folder, including a benchmark script for the twenty model comparison. Each script writes the model file, its metadata and an evaluation JSON file. The backend reads these files and never recomputes or edits the metrics. Earlier versions are preserved, and new versions are added alongside them.

Table 4.5 Model versions

Version	Dataset and task	Selected model	Validation
v1	INDOFLOODS, severe versus flood	Random Forest, with XGBoost compared	Held-out 910 events
v2	INDOFLOODS, peak level and severe flag	LightGBM with log target and CatBoost	Five-fold GroupKFold with a holdout of 31 gauges
v3	As v2, tail-weighted regressor	Tail-weighted LightGBM and CatBoost	Same as v2
v4	CAMELS-IND, flood in the next 3 days	XGBoost depth 6 refit on all training rows at threshold 0.45	Time split and unseen gauges

For version 4, seven candidates, namely logistic regression, random forest, histogram gradient boosting, XGBoost with depth 4, 6 and 8, and depth-6 XGBoost refit on all 1,641,197 training rows, were compared on the 349,645 validation rows. The selection rule was maximum validation balanced accuracy with PR-AUC as tie-break, and the decision threshold of 0.45 was also chosen on validation, so the test set was used only once.

4.11 System Design Diagrams

The architecture diagram in Figure 4.1, the workflow in Figure 4.2, the rescue stage machine in Figure 4.3 and the HQRL pipeline in Figure 4.4 were presented above. Figure 4.5 shows the deployment diagram.

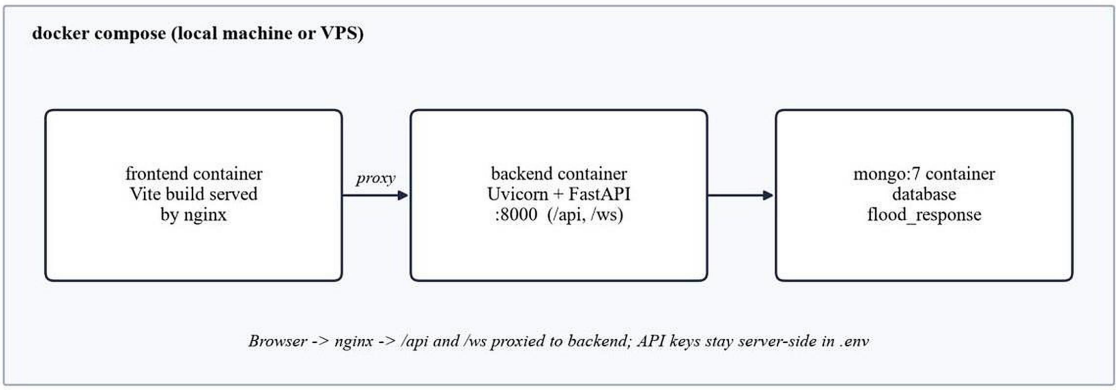


Figure 4.5 Deployment diagram using docker compose

4.12 Implementation

The backend is an asynchronous FastAPI application. On start-up the lifespan handler connects to MongoDB, loads the models, seeds shelters and teams if the database is empty, and starts the 90-second live ticker. If MongoDB is unavailable the APIs still run and return explicit unavailable states. Requests are validated with Pydantic, CORS is restricted to configured origins, SlowAPI provides rate limiting, operators log in with JWT for review actions, and every response carries standard security headers for content type, framing, referrer, permissions and content security policy.

The frontend is built with Vite. API calls go through a single API service module, and a single shared WebSocket client reconnects with exponential back-off up to 15 seconds and sends heartbeats. The simulation page keeps one authoritative state in the scenario context, and the live rescue view model derives unit positions from the stage start time, stage duration and route polyline without storing positions anywhere.

For deployment, a Docker Compose file starts three containers, namely the nginx served frontend, the Uvicorn backend and MongoDB 7, and a deployment script installs Docker, clones the repository and starts the stack on a VPS.

4.13 Coding and Program Implementation

GitHub repository: https://github.com/balasan12626/MINIPROJECT

The repository is organised as follows:

Table 4.6 Repository file structure

Path	Contents
backend/main.py	FastAPI app, lifespan, routers, security headers, /ws endpoint
backend/api/	Routers: health, live, ml, agents, response, simulation, hqrl, emergency, sources, rescue_desk, voice_agent, dams

Path	Contents
backend/services/	Pipeline, weather, hydrology, decision, shelter, route, priority, SOS clustering, person_ops, rescue desk, dam risk, voice agent, algorithm arena, report
backend/ml/	Inference, features (v1–v4), forecast_v4, risk engine, SHAP explanations, change monitor
backend/agents/	Agent graph and LLM agent radio
backend/optimization/	QUBO cost matrix and solvers
backend/simulation/	Digital-twin engine and HQRL benchmark engine
backend/thresholds.py	Single source of truth for all decision thresholds
backend/tests/	pytest suites (API, core, consistency, dams, ML, rescue ops, simulation)
frontend/src/pages/	LiveCommandCenter, LiveResponse, SimulationLab, RescueRoute, HqrlDemo
frontend/src/components/	Maps, charts, agent list, dam monitor, scenario panels, rescue panels
frontend/src/state/	ScenarioContext and rescueOps view model with tests
models/	Model artefacts, metadata and evaluation JSON files
scripts/	Training, benchmarking and VPS deployment scripts
dataset/	INDOFLOODS and CAMELS-IND files (training only)

The following excerpts are taken directly from the repository.

Code 4.1 Gated decision policy, simplified

```
if flood_probability < monitor:
    action = "MONITOR"
elif flood_probability < auto:
    action = "HUMAN_REVIEW"
else:
    action = "AUTOMATED_RESPONSE"
    if not (settings.automation_enabled and data_quality_ok
            and model_ok and system_ok):
        action = "HUMAN_REVIEW"
        reason += " - safety gate blocked automation"
```

The policy never acts automatically unless automation is enabled and the data, model and database gates are healthy. The reason string is stored with every decision.

Code 4.2 Flood-aware edge cost

```
RESCUE_SPEED_KMH = 25.0

def _edge_cost(u, v, road, dest_lat, dest_lon):
    if road and (road.get("blocked")
                 or not road.get("accessible", True)):
        return None          # blocked edge is removed from the graph
    dist = haversine_km(*GRAPH_NODES[u], *GRAPH_NODES[v])
    traffic = float((road or {}).get("traffic") or 0.4)
    flood = float((road or {}).get("flood_exposure") or 0.2)
    return dist * (1.0 + 0.8 * traffic + 1.4 * flood)
```

Code 4.3 QUBO cost matrix

```
for i, z in enumerate(zones):
    for j, s in enumerate(shelters):
        dist = haversine_km(z["lat"], z["lon"], s["lat"], s["lon"])
        travel = dist * (1.0 + 0.7 * traffic)
        flood = float(s.get("flood_risk") or 0) * 8.0
        seats = max(int(s.get("capacity", 0))
                    - int(s.get("occupancy", 0)), 1)
        overload = max(0.0, z["population"] / seats)
        c[i, j] = (0.30*travel + 0.25*dist + 0.20*flood
                   + 0.10*traffic*5 + 0.15*overload)
```

Code 4.4 Rescue clock

```
# queued -> assigned -> en_route -> to_shelter -> rescued
TIME_SCALE = 120.0       # 1 wall second = 2 simulated minutes
DISPATCH_SECONDS = 3.0   # wall s between successive admin dispatches
MOBILISE_SECONDS = 2.0   # wall s crew roll-out once assigned
```

Code 4.5 WebSocket reconnect with back-off

```
function scheduleReconnect() {
  if (intentionalClose || refCount <= 0) return;
  clearTimers();
  const delay = Math.min(15000, 800 * 2 ** Math.min(tries, 4));
  tries += 1;
  reconnectTimer = setTimeout(openSocket, delay);
}
```

4.14 User Interface and Application Screens

The user interface has a common top bar with the AquaSentinel brand, a LIVE OPS or SIM MODE badge, the active ML model version read from the backend, a light and dark theme toggle and navigation. The main screens are summarised in Table 4.7.

Table 4.7 Application screens

Screen	Main content
Live Command Center	Weather, rainfall, river and dam cards with source badges, ML and operational flood probability, agent list and agent radio, flood map and measured latencies
Live Response	Incidents, policy decision with approve and reject controls, shelter ranking, flood-aware routes and optimisation results
Simulation Lab	Scenario picker and inputs, RUN SCENARIO, digital twin outputs, Dam Monitor, ML benchmark, and HQRL benchmark with ablation
Rescue Route	Live rescue map with animated units, live SOS roster with stage badges, event feed and voice SOS

Figure 4.6 shows the Live Command Center at a moment when the live data feeds could not be reached. The status bar confirms that the backend and WebSocket are connected, while the KPI cards for rainfall, the Yamuna stage at ITO, the hybrid flood probability and the risk level show the explicit DATA UNAVAILABLE state instead of invented values,

which is the behaviour required in Section 4.4.1. When the feeds are reachable, the same cards show the live readings, and the panel below compares the raw ML probability with the operational risk and prints the exact formula used.

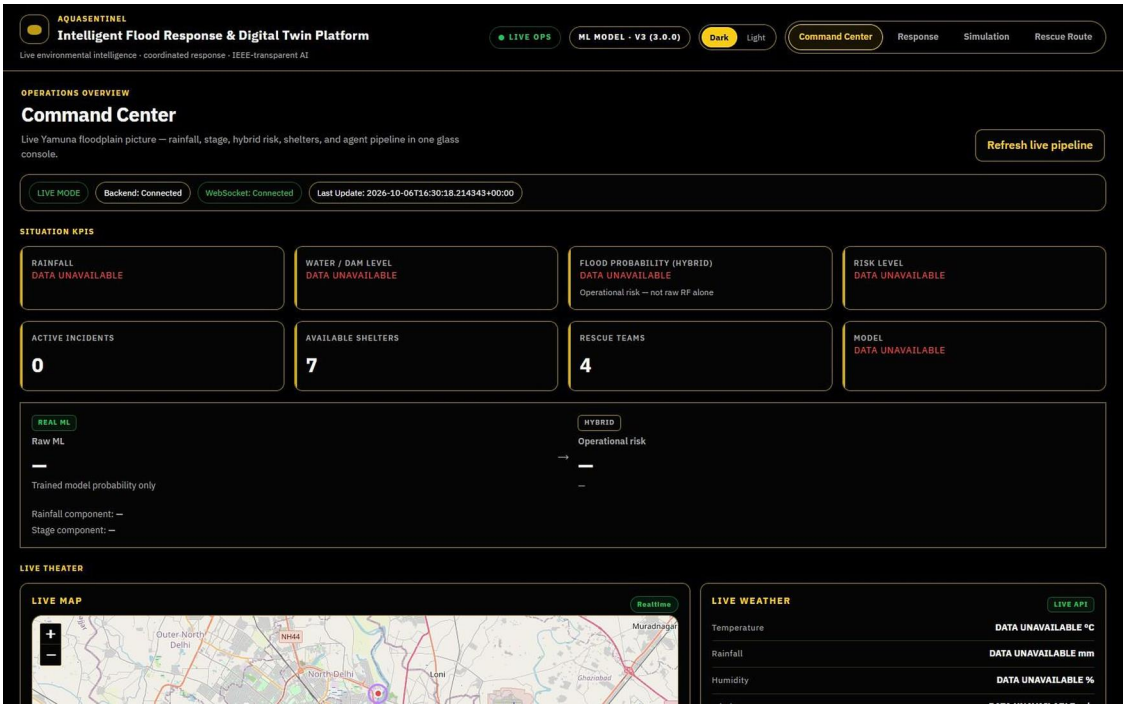


Figure 4.6 Live Command Center screen

Figure 4.7 shows the Simulation Lab after running the Heavy Rainfall scenario. The result cards give the reservoir risk, projected peak level, release and inflow, the best evacuation planner and the safe-evacuation percentage. Below them, the Dam Monitor shows the calculated reservoir fill for Bhakra Dam beside the ML risk prediction, and the advanced risk engine combines the two.

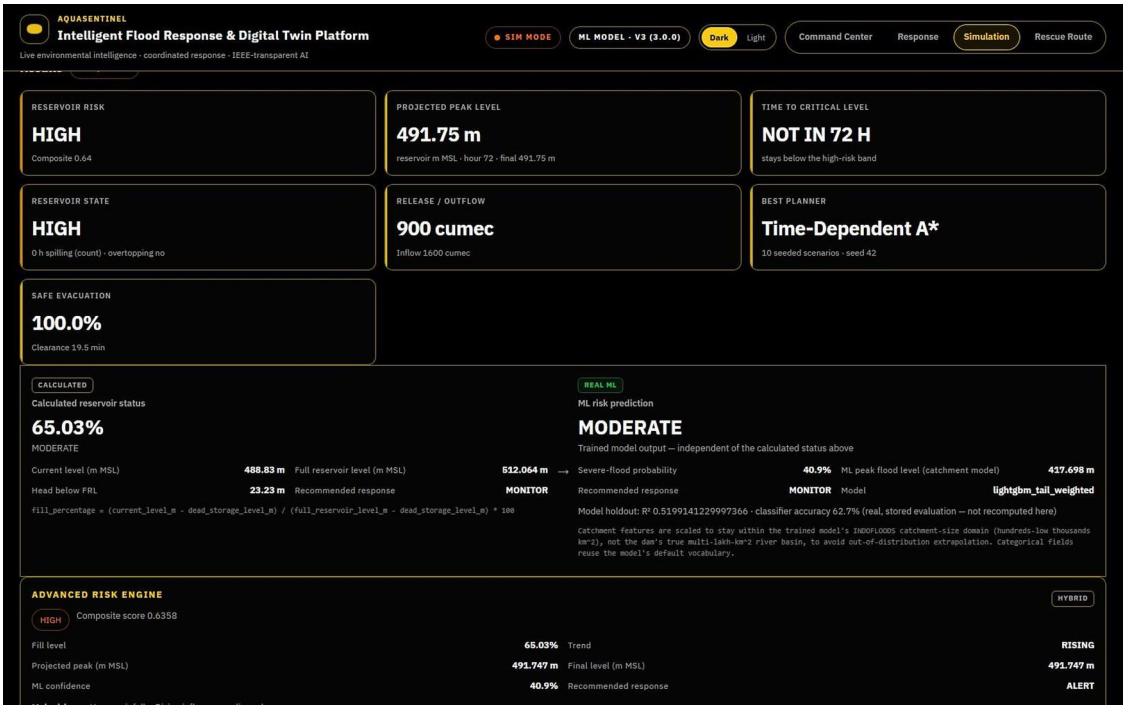


Figure 4.7 Simulation Lab, heavy rainfall scenario results and Dam Monitor

Figure 4.8 shows the Rescue Route screen after the simulation residents were pulled into the rescue desk. SOS locations appear as pins on the Delhi map, coloured by status, and the person-case table lists each case with its status, assigned ambulance and shelter.

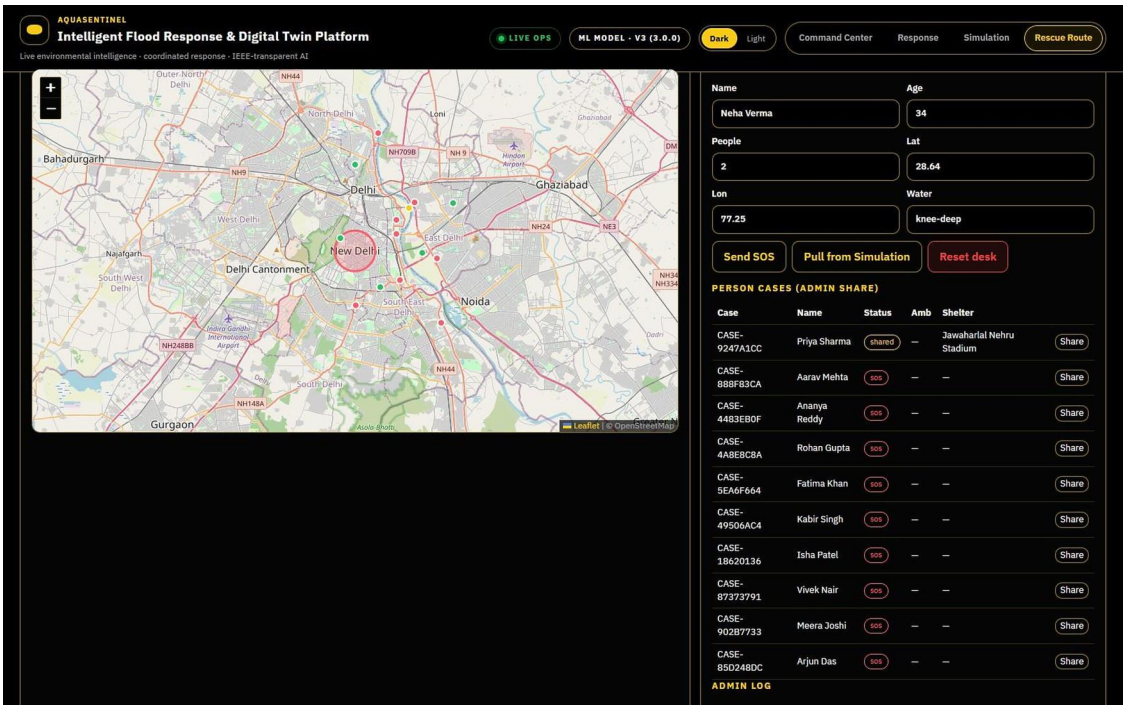


Figure 4.8 Rescue Route, live map and SOS case roster

4.15 Chapter Summary

This chapter presented the design and implementation of AquaSentinel: a five-layer architecture centred on one shared pipeline, ten modules, the algorithms for risk, policy,

routing, optimisation, triage and constraint-aware RL routing, the datasets and leakage-free preprocessing, four model versions, the design diagrams, the code organisation and the user interface.

5. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

5.1 Introduction

This chapter reports the measured results of the flood models, the 20-model benchmark, the HQRL routing benchmark and the automated tests. All numbers are read from the evaluation files in the models folder or produced by running the repository code with fixed seeds. None are estimated.

5.2 Experimental Setup

Training and benchmarks were run on the development machine described in Table 4.1, which has an Intel Core i5-1135G7 processor, 8 GB RAM and no GPU, using the Python libraries in Table 4.2. INDOFLOODS models used a held-out set of 910 events for version 1 and 31 unseen gauges with 788 events for versions 2 and 3. The version 4 model used 1,641,197 training rows from seen gauges from 1980 to 2008, 349,645 validation rows from 2009 to 2014, a primary test of 52,994 rows from 49 unseen gauges from 2015 to 2020 and a secondary test of 209,149 rows from seen gauges. The 20-model benchmark trained every model on the same 100,000-row sample for fairness. The HQRL benchmark used 30 synthetic scenarios with base seed 42 and the default configuration of 6 groups, 3 shelters, flood severity 0.35, traffic 0.40 and 8 vehicles.

5.3 Evaluation Metrics

- Accuracy is the share of all days that are classified correctly, and balanced accuracy is the average of recall and specificity, which is the main metric because floods are rare, at 5.5 percent of test days.
- Precision is the share of predicted floods that are real, recall is the share of real floods that are detected, and the F1 score is their harmonic mean. Recall is critical because a missed flood is costlier than a false alarm.
- ROC-AUC and PR-AUC summarise ranking quality across thresholds. PR-AUC is informative under class imbalance.
- Brier score measures calibration of the probabilities.
- MAE, RMSE and R^2 evaluate the peak-flood-level regressor.
- For routing: safe-evacuation percentage, unsafe-route percentage, mean clearance time, capacity violations and replanning latency.

5.4 Experimental Results

5.4.1 Version 1: INDOFLOODS Severe-Flood Classifiers

Table 5.1 v1 test metrics on 910 held-out events

Model	Accuracy	Precision	Recall	F1	ROC-AUC	Brier
Random Forest, selected	0.768	0.699	0.620	0.657	0.818	0.163
XGBoost at threshold 0.64	0.758	0.702	0.564	0.626	0.806	0.182

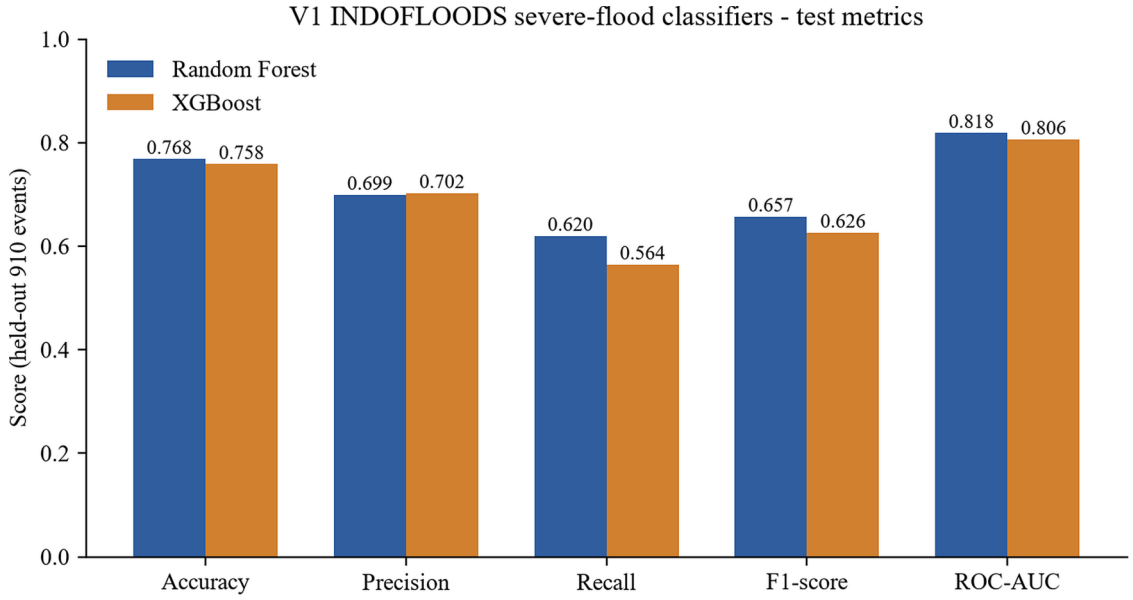


Figure 5.1 v1 classifier test metrics

A gauge-majority classifier already scores about 75.7 percent on this label, so the 76.8 percent of the Random Forest is close to the ceiling for this target. For this reason the v1 score is used only as a prior in the operational risk engine.

5.4.2 Versions 2 and 3: Peak Level and Severe Flag on Unseen Gauges

Table 5.2 v2 and v3 results on 31 unseen gauges with 788 events

Model	MAE	RMSE	R^2
v2 regressor, LightGBM with log target	80.08	130.47	0.488
v3 regressor, tail-weighted LightGBM	82.52	126.35	0.520

The v2 CatBoost severe-flood classifier reached accuracy 0.627, precision 0.478, recall 0.671, F1 0.559 and ROC-AUC 0.695 on the unseen gauges. These much lower numbers compared with v1 show the effect of removing gauge identity: once the model cannot memorise the station, the severe-flood label is hard to predict from rainfall alone.

5.4.3 Version 4: 3-Day Flood Forecast on CAMELS-IND

Table 5.3 v4 candidate models on validation data from 2009 to 2014 with 349,645 rows

Candidate	Bal. acc.	Recall	Precision	ROC-AUC	PR-AUC
Logistic regression	0.899	0.916	0.391	0.964	0.751
Random forest	0.905	0.924	0.403	0.969	0.781
Hist. gradient boosting	0.909	0.930	0.408	0.971	0.791
XGBoost depth 4	0.909	0.934	0.401	0.971	0.790
XGBoost depth 6	0.909	0.925	0.420	0.971	0.792
XGBoost depth 8	0.909	0.927	0.416	0.971	0.793
XGBoost depth 6 full refit, selected	0.911	0.936	0.404	0.972	0.796

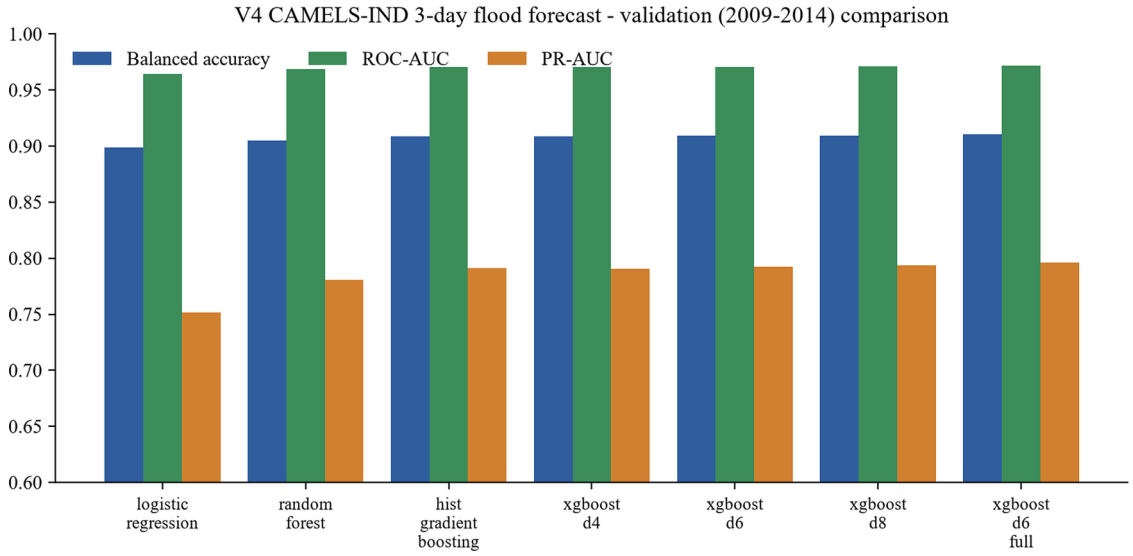


Figure 5.2 v4 candidate comparison on validation data

Table 5.4 v4 test results on 49 unseen gauges from 2015 to 2020 with 52,994 rows

Method	Accuracy	Bal. acc.	Precision	Recall	F1	ROC-AUC
v4 XGBoost at threshold 0.45	0.894	0.898	0.328	0.902	0.481	0.965
Persistence baseline	0.968	0.765	0.789	0.538	0.640	0.765
Always “no flood”	0.945	0.500	NA	0.000	NA	NA

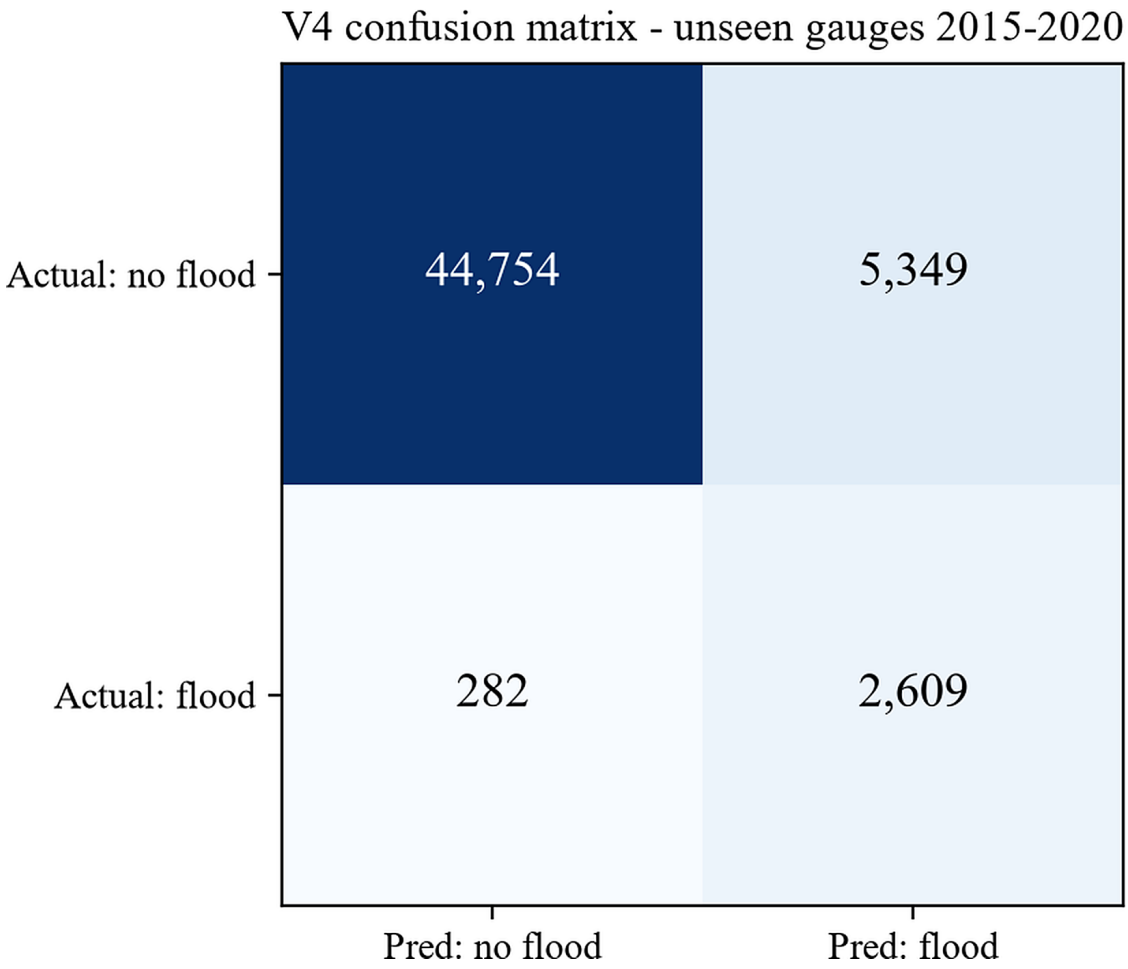


Figure 5.3 v4 confusion matrix on unseen gauges

On gauges never seen in training, the model detected 2,609 of 2,891 flood days, a recall of 0.902, with a Brier score of 0.065. On flood onsets only, meaning days when the river was not already flooding, recall was 0.813 with ROC-AUC 0.940.

5.4.4 Twenty-Model Benchmark

Twenty classifiers were evaluated with six checks. T1 requires test accuracy of at least 0.85, T2 requires test balanced accuracy of at least 0.85, T3 requires a train and test balanced accuracy gap of at most 0.05, T4 requires train balanced accuracy of at least 0.80, T5 requires beating the baseline and T6 requires a validation and test gap of at most 0.05 on unseen gauges. On the old INDOFLOODS task no model passed more than three checks, the best test balanced accuracy was 0.647 from the RBF SVM, and every model was underfit or overfit. On the CAMELS-IND forecast task, 14 of 20 models passed all six checks, and test balanced accuracy ranged from 0.865 to 0.896, with Random Forest and Bagged Trees at 0.896. This confirms that the improvement came from choosing a forecastable target and richer data, not from a particular algorithm.

5.4.5 HQRL Routing Benchmark

Table 5.5 HQRL benchmark, 30 synthetic scenarios, seed 42

Method	Safe evacuation percent	Unsafe route percent	Clearance minutes	Capacity violations	Route changes
Static shortest path	90.0	10.0	16.63	0.20	0.00
Time-dependent A*	100.0	0.0	17.81	0.00	0.23
Risk-aware greedy	90.0	10.0	16.63	0.20	0.00
PPO with RL only	90.0	10.0	16.63	0.20	0.00
PPO with classical QUBO	100.0	0.0	17.81	0.00	0.20
PPO with QAOA, called HQRL	100.0	0.0	17.82	0.00	0.23

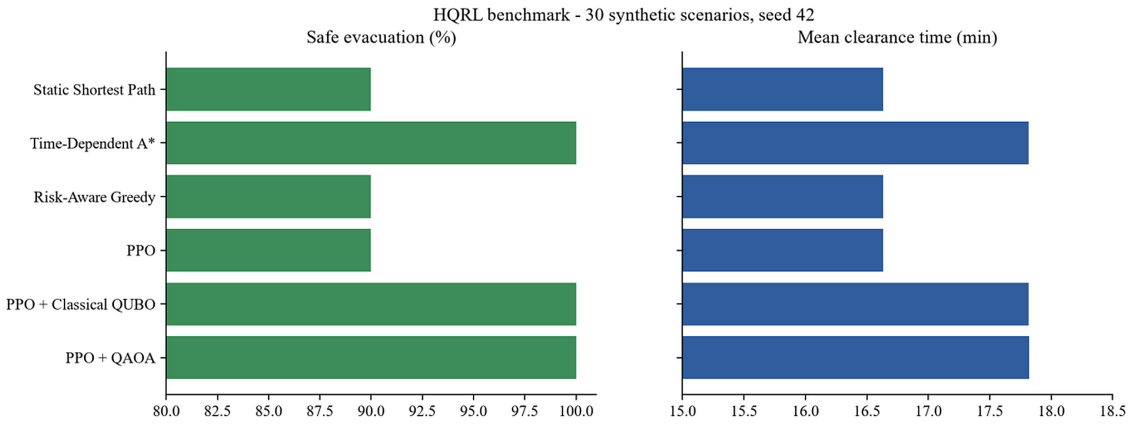


Figure 5.4 HQRL benchmark: safe evacuation and clearance time

In the ablation over 20 scenarios, RL without the safety layer achieved 92.5 percent safe evacuation, 7.5 percent unsafe routes and 0.15 capacity violations, whereas full HQRL achieved 100 percent, 0 percent and 0.00 respectively, at the cost of about one extra minute of clearance time, 17.57 minutes versus 16.58 minutes. Replanning latency is a few milliseconds to about 20 milliseconds per decision on the development machine, and latency values depend on the hardware and are reported only as indicative.

5.4.6 Automated Tests

The backend test suite, covering the API, core logic, data consistency, dam physics, dams, ML inference, version 4 ML, rescue operations and simulation, passed 75 of 75 tests. The frontend test suite passed 66 of 68 tests, and the two failures are in the dam monitor test, where the mock map in the test does not implement the set view function. This is a gap in the test mock, not in the application logic, and it is listed as future work.

5.5 Comparison with Existing Techniques

Table 5.6 Comparison with existing approaches

Capability	Gauge thresholds	Stand-alone ML forecast	Static GIS plan	AquaSentinel
Forecast lead time	None, reactive	Hours to days	None	3 days with v4 plus live risk
Validated on unseen gauges	None	Often not	None	Yes, balanced accuracy 0.898
Explanation of prediction	Rule	Rarely	None	TreeSHAP on serving model
Decision with safety gates	Manual	No	Manual	Monitor, review or automatic response with gates
Routes react to blockages	No	No	No	Yes, recomputed at pickup
Hard capacity and closure constraints	None	None	Partly	Yes, QUBO with validation
Digital-twin rehearsal	No	No	No	Same pipeline on scenarios

Against the persistence baseline, the version 4 model trades some raw accuracy, 0.894 versus 0.968, for a much higher balanced accuracy, 0.898 versus 0.765, and recall, 0.902 versus 0.538, because persistence looks accurate only when most days are dry. Against RL-only routing, the HQRL safety layer removes all unsafe routes and capacity violations in the benchmark.

5.6 Discussion of Results

The results support three conclusions. First, the choice of target matters more than the choice of algorithm: the INDOFLOODS severe label is essentially a station property, while the CAMELS-IND three-day exceedance task is forecastable by many model families. Second, the v4 model favours recall, which is appropriate for warnings, but its precision of 0.33 means that roughly two of three alerts are false alarms. This is why the system routes such probabilities through a human-review band rather than acting automatically at low confidence. Third, hard constraints are what make learned routing safe: in the benchmark the speed advantage of RL-only routing comes entirely from using routes that a validator would reject.

These findings relate directly to the limitations identified in Chapter 3. Fragmentation is resolved by the shared pipeline, optimistic evaluation by unseen-gauge testing, opacity by SHAP on the serving model, silent automation by the gates, and static plans by route recomputation.

Limitations remain. The v4 model is served as a historical replay because no live observed-gauge feed is available. Live probabilities therefore rely on the hybrid operational risk engine. The road graph and shelter data are curated rather than live. The HQRL results come from a small synthetic graph, and the QAOA solver is a classical simulation. Dam figures are approximate public reference values, labelled as such in the interface.

5.7 Chapter Summary

The v4 XGBoost forecast reached 0.898 balanced accuracy, 0.902 recall and 0.965 ROC-AUC on unseen gauges. In addition, 14 of 20 models passed all six benchmark checks on the CAMELS-IND task, the HQRL safety layer gave 100 percent safe evacuation with zero capacity violations, and the automated tests confirm the behaviour of the backend and nearly all of the frontend.

6. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

6.1 Summary of the Project

The project set out to connect flood forecasting with the decisions that follow it. AquaSentinel implements a single pipeline of Sense, Predict, Reason, Decide, Optimize and Respond that serves both live operations and a digital twin. It ingests live weather and river data with explicit source labels, predicts flood risk with models trained and tested without leakage, decides under explicit safety gates, coordinates seven agents through an auditable event graph, computes shelters and flood-aware routes, solves a QUBO assignment with several solvers, triages SOS calls vulnerable-first and tracks every rescue through a stage machine driven by route travel times.

The important outcomes are:

- A production 3-day flood forecast with 0.898 balanced accuracy, 0.902 recall and 0.965 ROC-AUC on unseen gauges.
- A transparent, monotonic operational risk engine and a gated decision policy with audit logging.
- Flood-aware routing and QUBO-based shelter assignment that react to blockages and capacity.
- A constraint-aware HQRL routing pipeline that achieved 100 percent safe evacuation in a seed-fixed benchmark.
- A digital twin, a five-dam monitor, a voice SOS agent and a four-screen React dashboard driven entirely by backend state.
- 75 passing backend tests, 66 of 68 passing frontend tests and Docker-based deployment.

Each objective in Section 1.4 is met: live ingestion with provenance in Module 1, leakage-free models with faithful explanations in Module 2, a gated policy in Module 3, agent coordination in Module 4, routing and optimisation in Module 5, SOS triage and rescue tracking in Module 6, and the digital twin with reproducible benchmarks in Modules 7 and 8.

6.2 Conclusion

AquaSentinel shows that a flood-response platform can be both automated and trustworthy when every value comes from one authoritative state, every model is evaluated on data it

has never seen, every learned component is followed by hard constraints, and every automatic action is gated and logged. The project also shows the value of honest reporting: the INDOFLOODS experiments revealed a label that cannot be predicted well from rainfall, which led to the CAMELS-IND forecasting task and a substantially better model.

6.3 Future Scope

- Integrate authenticated India-WRIS and CWC gauge feeds so that the v4 model can run live instead of as a historical replay.
- Replace the curated road graph with OpenStreetMap road data and a live traffic feed, and add road-level inundation from flood maps.
- Extend the forecast to more regions, longer lead times and graph or sequence models that use upstream gauges [3], [4].
- Run the QUBO formulation on real quantum annealing or gate-based hardware and compare it fairly with classical solvers [20].
- Train the evacuation policy on realistic city-scale road networks and population data.
- Add multilingual voice SOS, such as Hindi and Tamil, together with SMS fallback and offline operation.
- Fix the Leaflet test mock so that the full frontend suite passes, and add end-to-end browser tests.
- Run field exercises with emergency professionals to co-design the interface, as recommended by [9].

SDG GOALS

This project contributes to the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals and to the priorities of the Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction 2015 to 2030.

SDG 11: Sustainable Cities and Communities, Target 11.5

Target 11.5 aims to significantly reduce the number of deaths and people affected by disasters, including water-related disasters. AquaSentinel supports this by forecasting floods three days ahead, choosing safe shelters with free capacity, computing flood-aware evacuation routes that avoid blocked roads, and prioritising children and elderly people in rescue dispatch. Target 11.b, on integrated policies for resilience to disasters, is supported by the gated, auditable decision policy.

SDG 13: Climate Action, Target 13.1

Target 13.1 calls for strengthening resilience and adaptive capacity to climate-related hazards. Climate change is increasing the intensity of extreme rainfall. The system turns rainfall, river-stage and reservoir data into early warnings and rehearsable response plans, and its digital twin lets authorities test plans for extreme-rainfall, emergency-release and worst-case-inflow scenarios before they happen.

SDG 3: Good Health and Well-being, Target 3.d

Target 3.d aims to strengthen capacity for early warning and management of health risks. The rescue desk assigns ambulances, tracks each person until they reach a shelter, and the voice SOS agent lowers the barrier to asking for help during an emergency.

SDG 9: Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure, Target 9.1

Target 9.1 promotes reliable and resilient infrastructure. The Dam Monitor tracks live-storage fill and response levels for five major reservoirs, and the routing engine models how flooding affects the road network, supporting resilient infrastructure planning.

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